

Also, do notice and remember that Virtualization helps a lot in cloud computing scenario but is not a mandatory part of it. So it is possible to create a cloud computing platform which does not depend on Virtualization. Such a system may not be as manageable as one using advanced Virtualization tools but would, by no means be deficient of features. All of this, certainly depends a lot on how the network of computers are managed and availed as a “service” or “infrastructure”.

We know all that might sound a bit complicated in the beginning with a whole lot of IT Administration terms thrown in and it is in fact, complicated. What we just wanted to point out is the role virtualization can play in cloud computing.

What does Virtualization look like?

Virtual machines may sound intimidating but is not as tough as one might think it is. There are a lot of software package available for a general user to try out the virtual machines. Some of them are quite famous, some are not. Some are free, some are not. Some are cross plat form, some are not. With a whole lot of options, you might just pick up the one which interests you and your wallet and get going.

Testing a new operating system cannot be easier than with a virtual machine. Remember one thing though – if you want to test your real hardware being compatible with an operating system, virtualization is the step you do NOT want to take.

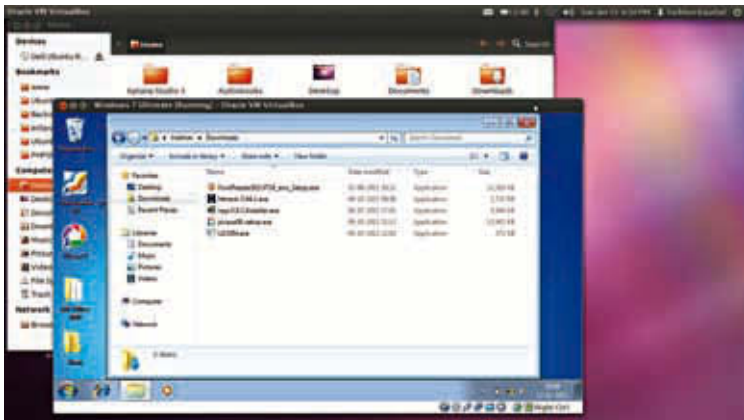


Figure 2: Windows 7 running inside an Ubuntu as a virtual machine using VirtualBox